DORSET & WILTSHIRE
FIRE AND RESCUE

Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Service
Five Rivers Community Health & Wellbeing Centre,
Hulse Road, Salisbury, Wiltshire SP1 3NR

Development Management
Swindon Borough Council
By Email

Case Officer: Edward Snook

Direct Line: (01722) 691717
Email: forwardplanning@dwfire.org.uk
Planning Application: S/RES/24/0947
My ref: L0005131
Date: 27 August 2024

Dear Edward

Section 106, Town & Country Planning Act 1990 (as amended)
B5 of Approved Document B, Building Regulations 2010

Address of Premises: Parcels R6 & R7, Land North of A420, Swindon

Proposal: **Application for 137 dwellings and associated infrastructure**

This application falls within the area for which Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Service is responsible for delivering an operational and emergency response.

Building Regulation Matters

In the event the planning permission is granted for this development, the development would need to be designed and built to meet current Building Regulations requirements. The Authority raises the profile of these future requirements through this early opportunity and requests the comments made under B5 of Approved Document B, The Building Regulations 2010 be made available to the applicant/planning agent as appropriate.

The assessment of this development proposal in respect of Building Control matters will be made during formal consultation, however early recommendations are identified on the attached schedules and relate to the following areas:

- Recommendations identified under B5 of Approved Document B relating to The Building Regulations 2010
- Recommendations to improve safety and reduce property loss in the event of fire

Yours sincerely

Ellie Gray
Business Fire Safety
On behalf of the Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Authority

Dorset & Wiltshire Fire & Rescue Service

Recommendations Identified under B5 of Approved Document B

Summary

At this stage of the planning application Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Service is required to make comment relating to section B5 of Approved Document B. Essentially, this relates to the provision of reasonable facilities to assist fire fighters within the building and to enable fire appliances to gain access to the building.

Complying with these requirements, in advance of the formal Building Regulations consultation process, will assist with the process and are made without prejudice to it.

Access and Facilities for the Fire Service

Consideration is to be given to ensure access to the site, for the purpose of firefighting, is adequate for the size and nature of the development.

Water Supplies for Fire Fighting

Consideration should be given to the National Guidance Document on the Provision of Water for Fire Fighting and the specific advice of this Authority on the location of fire hydrants.

The proposed development should be served by the necessary water supply and fire hydrants for use in the event of fire. It is important these requirements are established prior to the commencement of development. This ensures a firefighting water supply is in place during the construction phase, hydrants are connected at the right locations, at the right time and the cost is covered by the developer.

Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Service

Recommendations to improve safety and reduce property loss in the event of fire

Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Service's core objectives include the reduction of deaths, injuries and property damage caused by fire. The following recommendations are made with this in mind and, whilst not requirements, may become so during the formal Building Regulations consultation process and are made without prejudice to that process.

Domestic Sprinkler Protection

A core objective of the Dorset & Wiltshire Fire and Rescue Service is to support and encourage an increase in the provision of residential sprinklers in domestic properties. Residential sprinklers are not new and, although a British invention, significant developments have been made in the United States, Australia and New Zealand. In these countries there are whole communities with such installations and a zero fatality rate from domestic fires where a sprinkler system is installed. The following information may be of interest to you:

- Sprinklers work from a standard main, although a 32mm connection is required
- Are inexpensive to install, particularly in a new building
- Do not activate by accident causing unwanted damage
- Only operate through individually activated heads, not the whole system
- Are not unsightly as they fit flush to the ceiling behind a flat cover
- Cause less water damage in a fire than normal firefighting operations
- Significantly reduce fire and smoke damage
- If you would like more information on these systems please contact this Authority.